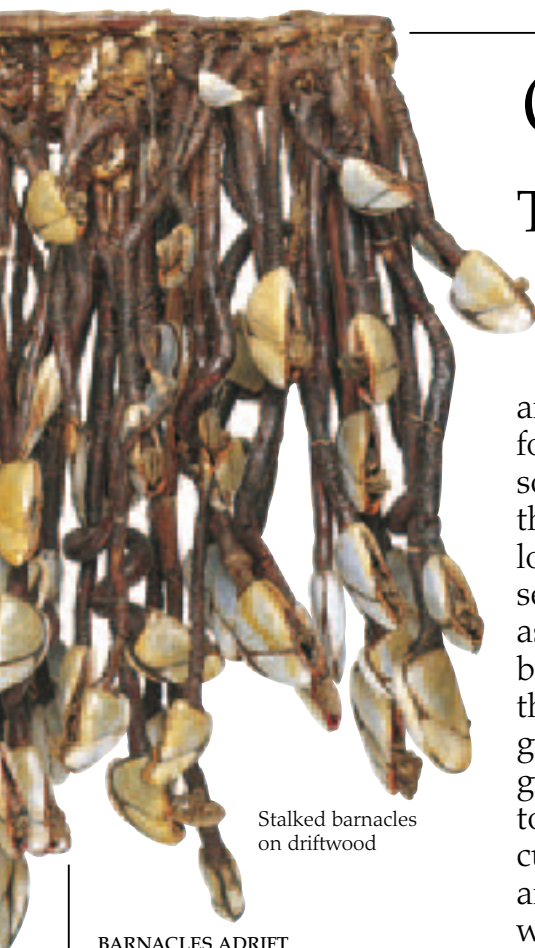


Ocean travelers

TO MAKE THE MOST of the vast expanses of water, some sea animals travel great distances, crisscrossing the oceans to find the best places to feed and breed. Whales, like the humpback, are known for feeding in the cold, food-rich waters of the far north or south, traveling to the warm waters of the tropics to breed and give birth. Many long-distance voyagers, such as turtles, seals, and seabirds, feed out at sea, but come ashore to breed. Freshwater eels are unusual because they go to the ocean to breed, then their young travel back to rivers where they grow to maturity. Salmon do the reverse, growing in the ocean and returning to rivers to breed. Ocean travelers often make use of currents to speed them on their way. Even animals that cannot swim can travel far and wide by hitching a ride on another animal or by drifting along on a piece of wood.

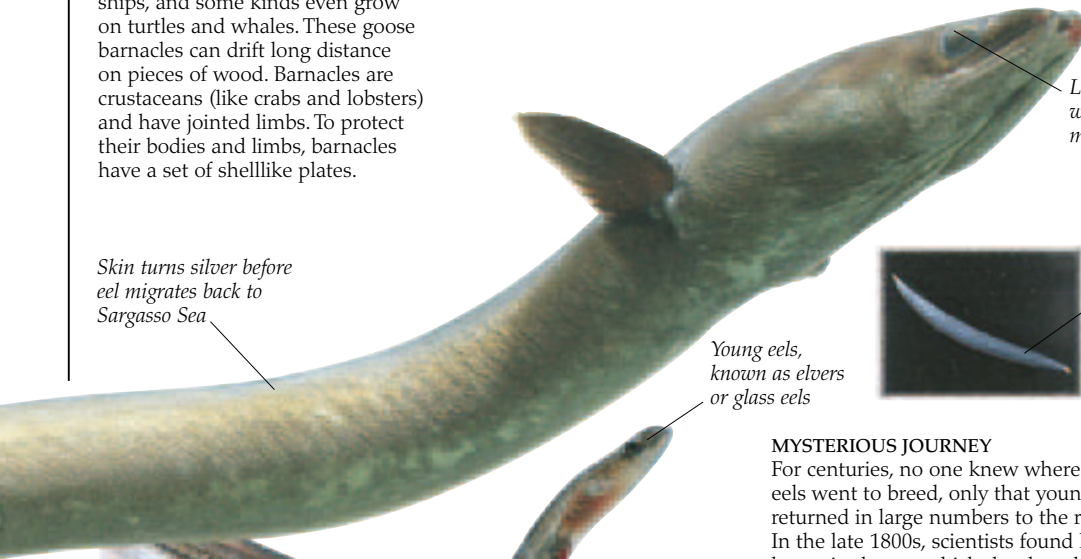


Stalked barnacles on driftwood

BARNACLES ADRIFT

Barnacles grow on surfaces, such as rocks, pieces of wood, hulls of ships, and some kinds even grow on turtles and whales. These goose barnacles can drift long distance on pieces of wood. Barnacles are crustaceans (like crabs and lobsters) and have jointed limbs. To protect their bodies and limbs, barnacles have a set of shelllike plates.

Skin turns silver before eel migrates back to Sargasso Sea



Larger eyes form when adult eel migrates to sea

Young eels, known as elvers or glass eels



Leaflike larva (young), called Leptocephalus

Trailing tentacles armed with vicious stings



PORTUGUESE MAN-OF-WAR

Not a true jellyfish but a siphonophore (a relative of sea firs), the man-of-war has a gas-filled float which keeps it at the surface where it is blown by the wind and drifts with the currents. Usually found in warm waters, it can be carried to cooler waters and washed ashore after storms.

MYSTERIOUS JOURNEY

For centuries, no one knew where European eels went to breed, only that young eels returned in large numbers to the rivers. In the late 1800s, scientists found leaflike larvae in the sea which developed into elvers. Later they found that the smallest larvae came from the Sargasso Sea in the western Atlantic where adult eels may breed at depth. The larvae then drift with currents back to the European coast where they turn into elvers.

